

c. 1951, September

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Sclanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

PRIVILEGED SACRIFICES. BY an Eye Witness

"Without Sacrafice You get nowhere." is quite a generally conceded principle. Fomr the ABC's of any science to the "master degree" no complete let up can be counted on, if outstanding success is to be the prize. And, selfunderstood, "the greater the prize in view, the greater also the sacrifice, i. e. the greater the efforts worth making and expected.

Yesterday and To-day at Saint Felix Friary--the Capuchin-Franciscan Novitiate, we witnessed something of such sacrifices. In each case it was a culmination of several years strenuous studies and of self-discipline. To-day seventeen novices--all young, promising youths between 17 and 23 I presume--pronounced their first vows, thereby, with the grace of God becoming Capuchin friars and crowning another year, outstanding in their individual lives a successful novitiate. The happy absence of any shade of reluctance or hesitation indicated to moistened-eyed community and audience something of the appreciation on part of the students present. Tomorrow and next day they leave for further progress toward the holy Priesthood in our Ser. College of the Immaculate Conception overlooking the lordly Hudson.

They will no doubt be missed here at the novitiate where for more than twelve months they have been endearing themselves to the older members of the local community. These, however, without exception will wish them God speed and blessing; -- happy in the confident hope that the promising twenty-five following in their steps since yesterday's not-less-touching ceremony of enrollment or clothing, will profit by such a happy example.